01 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Give the publication a useful purpose.

RELATIVE SLOT

S01 / explain / article

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Purpose

Help readers examine how context travels with material.

Editorial promise

Explain a task and offer a bounded practice.

Planning boundary

No live publication or actual readership established.

Which recurring reader question makes this series worth creating?



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Context Journal is a fictional editorial series about making working material easier to understand. Its purpose is to answer reader questions, not to fill an arbitrary posting quota.

Organise the plan around explanation, practice and reflection. These are editorial pillars, not audience-tested categories. The twelve-slot register is a working structure with no actual publication dates or committed contributors.

Purpose before cadence

A schedule should support the quality and usefulness of the work. It cannot establish that an audience exists or that the proposed cadence is feasible.

02 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Collect questions before assigning topics.

RELATIVE SLOT

S02 / practice / email

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Explain question

Why does a saved note lose its purpose?

Practice question

What context belongs beside an instruction?

Reflect question

When should the original explanation be revisited?

What should a reader understand or try after this piece?



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Why did I save this? What does the next person need? When should a note be revised? These questions create more useful starting points than broad promotional themes.

Treat the question pool as an editorial hypothesis. Actual reader inquiry needs an appropriate source and context. Do not present authored questions as survey findings or imply that they represent a community.

A question-led assignment

Each topic should connect a question to an intended takeaway. If the connection is weak, revise the brief before selecting a channel.

03 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Use pillars as editorial boundaries.

RELATIVE SLOT

S03 / reflect / social

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Explain

Clarify an idea and its limits.

Practice

Offer a specific activity with a review point.

Reflect

Examine an assumption or unresolved condition.

Does the proposed treatment fit its pillar's job?



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Explain clarifies a concept. Practice offers a small, inspectable activity. Reflect examines what remains uncertain after trying an approach. Each pillar has a different job.

The source plan assigns four slots to each pillar. Equal counts are a planning choice, not a recommendation about an optimal content mix or a report of previous performance.

Three pillars, three types of value

Keep the pillar visible in a brief so the writer knows whether to define, guide or question. A single article need not do all three equally.

04 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Build a pool before committing slots.

RELATIVE SLOT

S04 / explain / handout

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Topic route

Keep a question beside a saved passage.

Source need

An appropriate example with permission to use it.

Commitment status

Proposed only; no actual assignment.

Which idea has enough definition to move into a brief?



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Possible topics include a note with a question, a clearer handover, a source-context check and a revision note. Each can be shaped by a different reader task.

An idea belongs in the pool until its purpose, source needs and scope are clear. A promising title does not reserve a publication date or imply that a contributor has accepted the work.

From idea to viable brief

Separate backlog from scheduled work. The supplied twelve slots are relative planning units, not a real production calendar.

05 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Design recognisable editorial formats.

RELATIVE SLOT

S05 / practice / article

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Explainer

One idea, one concrete example, one limitation.

Practice sheet

One task, clear steps and a review question.

Reflection note

One assumption and a reason to revisit it.

What does this format make easier to understand?



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

A short explainer defines one idea. A practice sheet guides one task. A reflection note asks what the first explanation missed. Repetition of format can help readers know what to expect.

The format should support the material rather than force every topic into the same length. Accessibility, image rights and source checking remain part of the brief for each treatment.

Format is not a performance claim

No length, cadence or visual treatment is presented as proven to increase engagement. Choose a form that can communicate the task honestly.

06 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Make the brief usable by another editor.

RELATIVE SLOT

S06 / reflect / email

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Reader question

Why did I save this passage?

Takeaway

Write the question beside the material.

Evidence boundary

No measured improvement or customer result supplied.

Could another editor draft the piece without inventing its evidence?



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

A usable brief states the reader question, the intended takeaway and the evidence needed. It also identifies what the piece should not imply.

For a context-note practice sheet, the takeaway is to connect a saved passage with its purpose. The source need is an appropriate example; the boundary is that completing the exercise does not establish a productivity benefit.

An actual draft brief

Working title: Keep the question with the note. Treatment: a short explanation followed by a bounded annotation activity and a review question.

07 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Distribute without duplicating blindly.

RELATIVE SLOT

S07 / explain / social

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Article

Explain the task and its limits.

Email or social

Introduce one question and an honest next action.

Handout

Support an activity without implying a guaranteed result.

What does the reader need at this particular touchpoint?



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

The illustrative plan uses article, email, social and handout channels. Each appears in three relative slots, but the same treatment need not fit every channel.

An email can introduce the question, an article can explain the task, a social post can point to the explanation and a handout can support practice. These are proposed roles, not actual sends or reach.

Channel handoff

Retain the source link and the important qualification when shortening a piece. Verify real destinations before any release.

08 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Protect review time in the workflow.

RELATIVE SLOT

S08 / practice / handout

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Editorial check

The piece answers its stated reader question.

Source check

Claims match appropriate, reviewable material.

Rights check

Distribution and adaptation permissions are confirmed.

Which gate could still stop this piece from becoming ready?



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

Move from idea to brief, draft, review and ready only when the relevant work has happened. A status label should describe the artifact, not express optimism.

The supplied slot register remains proposed. No named writer, reviewer or publication authority is assigned. A real plan needs responsibility, accessible review routes and a method for handling corrections.

Review before readiness

Distinguish editorial review from product, source and rights checks. A reviewer’s name is not permission to publish material outside the agreed scope.

09 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Define observations before reporting rates.

RELATIVE SLOT

S09 / reflect / article

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Plan count

12 proposed slots; none marked published.

Missing measurement

No audience or delivery observations supplied.

Review question

Did the piece answer its intended reader question?

What observation would speak to the stated purpose?

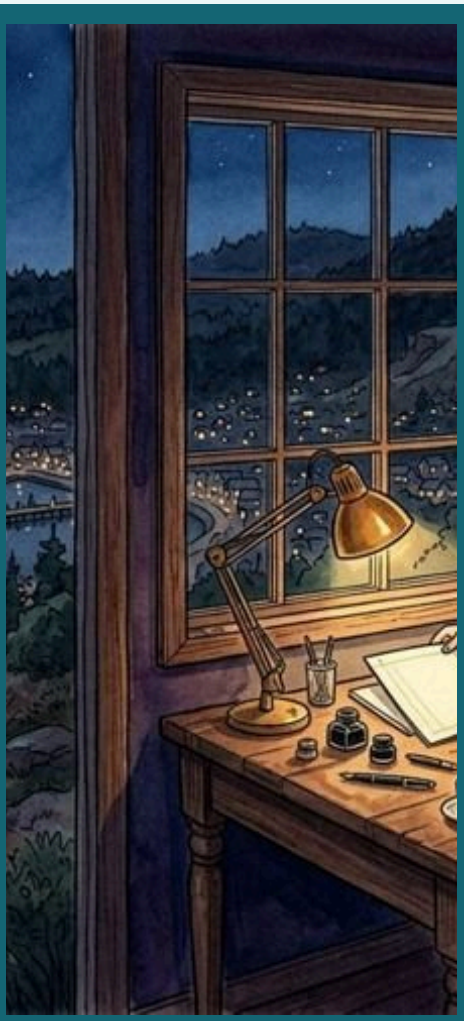


Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

A real review might examine delivery, reading, questions received or completion of an activity. Each observation needs a definition, time window and relevant denominator.

This plan contains no audience, traffic or engagement data. Twelve proposed slots are not twelve published pieces, and an equal channel count is not evidence of equal reach or value.

Planning counts are not outcomes

Choose observations that fit the editorial purpose. Do not substitute a convenient platform number for whether the explanation helped a reader understand the task.

10 / EDITORIAL CALENDAR

Use the review to change the next brief.

RELATIVE SLOT

S10 / explain / email

PLANNING MODEL

12 proposed slots; no actual dates, publication or audience.

PILLAR / BRIEF / REVIEW

Keep

A clear relationship between question and treatment.

Change

Any explanation that obscures its limits.

Investigate

Actual reader needs and feasible editorial capacity.

Which revision would make the next piece more useful?

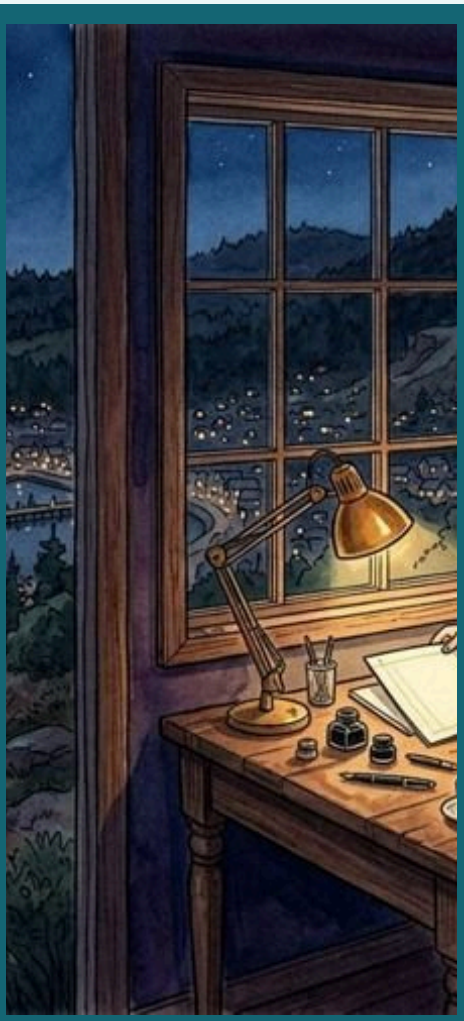


Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

After actual publication, identify which questions the piece answered and which it left unresolved. Retain corrections and source changes as part of the editorial record.

The next cycle should respond to appropriate evidence rather than merely repeat the same slot pattern. This fictional plan provides no results, so it cannot identify a winning pillar, channel or cadence.

A learning record for the next cycle

Carry forward one useful revision to the brief, one unresolved source issue and one question worth returning to. Keep proposed work separate from completed publication.